

AoE2 Tournament Agent

Discord Server Admin Guide

For community hosts managing their own tournament

You received a tournament URL and admin password from the platform organiser. This guide walks you through every step of running your community's tournament.

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1. What You Have Access To

The platform organiser has created a tournament specifically for your community. You have been given:

Item	What It Is
Tournament URL	The web address for your community's tournament. Share this with your players.
Admin Password	Your private password to access the admin panel for your tournament only.
Isolated Tournament	Your players, brackets, and data are completely separate from all other communities.

What you control:

- 1 Season name, dates, and structure
- 2 ELO division names and ranges
- 3 Time windows for scheduling matches
- 4 Placement match settings (map, resources, speed)
- 5 Prize pool fee amount and your PayPal email (required before launch)
- 6 Prize splits per division (1st/2nd/3rd place %)
- 7 Confirming player payments as Received
- 8 Player bans and reports

What the platform organiser controls:

- 1 Platform hosting and technical upkeep
- 2 Platform admin fee amount (you see it as read-only)
- 3 Creating and deleting tournaments
- 4 Master password and platform-level settings

2. Logging Into Your Admin Panel

- 1 Open your tournament URL in a browser.
- 2 Click **Admin** in the navigation bar at the top.
- 3 A lock screen appears. Enter your admin password.
- 4 Click **Unlock** (or press Enter).
- 5 The admin panel opens with tabs across the top.
- 6 When finished, always click **Lock Admin** to close your session.

First time logging in? Change your password immediately. Go to Admin → Passwords → Change Admin Password. Choose something secure that you won't forget.

The master password also works as a backup (held by the platform organiser). If you forget yours, contact the organiser.

3. First-Time Setup Checklist

Complete these steps before opening registration:

Step	Where	Done?
Change admin password	Admin → Passwords	☐
Set season name	Admin → Season	☐
Add your PayPal email	Admin → Season	☐
Set prize fee amount	Admin → Season	☐
Configure ELO divisions	Admin → Tiers	☐
Set prize splits per division	Admin → Tiers	☐
Set time windows	Admin → Time Windows	☐
Set placement match settings	Admin → Placement	☐
Prepare Discord announcement	Discord tab	☐
Open registration	Admin → Season	☐

Without a PayPal email on file, you cannot open paid division brackets. The app will block the action with a warning until this is filled in.

4. Configuring Season Settings

Go to **Admin** → **Season**.

First — add your PayPal email. This is required before you can open any paid division bracket. Players send your prize fee share directly to this address.

Your PayPal Email field turns green with a ✓ once filled in. Leaving it blank shows a red warning and blocks bracket launch for paid tournaments.

Setting	What to Enter	Tip
Season Name	e.g. Summer 2025 or NA Kings S1	Shown on your tournament home page
Placement Games	Default: 5	More games = more accurate ELO
Swiss Rounds	Default: 7	7 is correct for 100–200 players
Top N Playoff	Default: 8 (Top 8)	Can be 4, 8, or 16
Platform Admin Fee	Read-only — set by the platform organiser	Contact them to request a change
Prize Pool Fee	Your prize amount per player	e.g. \$10 per player
Additional Payment Notes	Optional public note shown to players	e.g. "Include your Discord tag"

Prize fee note: This is the per-player contribution to your prize pool. With 80 players at \$10 each, your prize pool is \$800. You decide the 1st/2nd/3rd split per division on the Tiers page (Section 5).

5. Configuring ELO Divisions (Tiers) & Prize Splits

Go to **Admin** → **Tiers**. Each division is a separate ELO bracket with its own Swiss tournament, champion, and prize split.

The default setup has 4 divisions. You can rename, adjust ranges, or add more:

Division	Default ELO Range	How to Adjust
Bronze	0 – 499	Edit Min and Max ELO fields
Silver	500 – 799	Edit Min and Max ELO fields
Gold	800 – 1099	Edit Min and Max ELO fields
Diamond	1100 and up	Leave Max blank = no upper limit

To add a division: click **+ Add Division** at the bottom.

To remove a division: click the red **X** button (minimum 2 divisions required).

Prize splits per division:

Each division card has ■ 1st, ■ 2nd, and ■ 3rd place percentage fields (default 60/25/15). These should total 100%. As you type, the app shows the live dollar amount for each place based on confirmed payments so far.

Place	Default %	Example with \$800 pool
■ 1st	60%	\$480
■ 2nd	25%	\$200
■ 3rd	15%	\$120

Live Prize Pool shown on the Tiers page updates automatically — every time a player's payment status becomes "Received," the pool grows by that division's prize fee amount.

Set your tier ranges and prize splits BEFORE opening registration — the placement system classifies players into tiers based on ELO, so your ranges need to be final before any games are played.

6. Setting Time Windows

Go to **Admin** → **Time Windows**. Time windows tell the agent which days and hours to schedule placement matches. All times are UTC.

Click + **Add Time Window** to add a window. Each window has:

- 1 **Day** — which day of the week (Monday through Sunday)
- 2 **Start Hour UTC** — when matches can start (0–23)
- 3 **End Hour UTC** — when the window closes (0–23)
- 4 **Label** — a friendly name for your reference (e.g. Saturday afternoon)

Your Community		Example Windows to Add
North American players		Saturday 18:00–23:00 UTC and Sunday 18:00–23:00 UTC
European players		Saturday 13:00–21:00 UTC and Sunday 13:00–21:00 UTC
Mixed US + Europe		Saturday 16:00–21:00 UTC (works for both regions)
No preference		Leave empty — matches spread in 2-hour gaps

Players always see scheduled times in their own registered timezone — you don't need to worry about converting times for them.

7. Setting Placement Match Rules

Go to **Admin** → **Placement**. These settings apply to all ELO classification games.

Setting	Default	Notes
Map	Random Map	Standard for placement — fair for all civs
Resources	Standard	Change to High Resources if your community prefers
Game Speed	Normal	Most players use Normal or Fast
Game Mode	Random Map	Standard 1v1 mode
Spectator Delay	10 minutes	Cannot go below 10 min — prevents info leaking
Recording Required	Yes	Strongly recommended — needed for dispute resolution
Notes	—	Add any special rules visible to players (e.g. No rushing before 5 min)

8. Opening Registration — Announcing to Your Server

Go to **Admin** → **Season** → **Open Registration**. Then announce to your Discord server.

Go to the **Discord** tab in your tournament nav. Click **Copy** under the Tournament Announcement. Paste it into your server's announcement channel.

The announcement includes:

- 1 Your tournament name and season
- 2 Your tournament URL (players click it to register)
- 3 The number of placement games and how divisions work
- 4 Entry fee details and payment instructions
- 5 Division ELO ranges

What players need to do:

- 1 Click the tournament URL.
- 2 Click Register and fill in their details.
- 3 Pay the entry fee using your payment instructions.
- 4 Wait for you to mark their payment as received.
- 5 Log in and check their portal for their placement match schedule.

Tell players: Registration is free. Placement games are free. The entry fee only applies when they enter their division bracket. This encourages more signups.

9. Closing Registration & Generating the Schedule

When your registration period is over, go to **Admin** → **Season** and click **Close & Generate Schedule**.

The agent will **immediately and automatically**:

- 1 Pair every player with their 5 placement opponents (ELO-balanced, no rematches).
- 2 Assign time slots from your configured time windows, spread evenly.
- 3 Generate a unique lobby name and password for every match.
- 4 Show every player their full schedule the next time they log in.

This is your most important step. After this, the tournament runs itself. Players see their matches, play them, report results, and advance through the bracket — without you doing anything.

After generating the schedule, post in your Discord server:

Registration is now closed. Log into [your tournament URL] to see your placement match schedule. Play all 5 matches to be classified into your division!

10. Verifying Payments

Go to **Admin** → **Payments**. This page shows every player's payment status with three possible states.

Status	What It Means
■ No Payment Submitted	Player hasn't paid or hasn't told the app they paid yet
■ Submitted — Awaiting Confirmation	Player clicked "I've Paid Both Fees" in their portal
■ Received — Can Play	You confirmed the money arrived — they can now play

How a player pays you:

- 1 Player logs into their portal. A Payment section shows two PayPal buttons: one for the Admin Fee (goes to the platform organiser), one for the Prize Fee (goes to YOUR PayPal email).
- 2 Each PayPal link is pre-filled with the amount and a note: the player's email, the tournament name, and their Discord tag.
- 3 After paying both, the player clicks **"I've Paid Both Fees"** in their portal. Their status becomes Submitted.

How you confirm receipt:

- 1 Check your PayPal account for the incoming payment, matching it to the player using the note (email/tournament/Discord tag).
- 2 Go to **Admin** → **Payments** in your tournament.
- 3 Find the player showing "Submitted" status and click **Confirm Received**.
- 4 Their status becomes Received — they are now eligible to play in the paid tournament bracket.

Only Received players count. When you open division brackets, only players with Received status (or all classified players if there's no fee) are included. Placement games remain free for everyone regardless of payment status.

Mistake correction: If you confirm someone by accident, click "Revert to Submitted" next to their name to undo it before the bracket has started.

11. Opening Division Brackets

Once enough players have completed their placement games and been classified, go to **Admin** → **Season** and click **Open Division Brackets**.

The agent opens all qualifying divisions simultaneously. A division needs at least 2 classified players to open.

After opening, post in your Discord:

Division brackets are now open! Log in to vote on your division's map and game settings. Voting closes [date].

Players vote on Map, Resources, and Speed for their division from their portal. You can see the vote tallies in real time in the Divisions tab.

12. Locking Settings & Starting Swiss

- 1 Go to the **Divisions** tab in your tournament.
- 2 For each division, you will see the vote tallies for Map, Resources, and Speed.
- 3 When you're satisfied the vote is complete, click **Lock Settings**.
- 4 The winning option for each category is locked in for the entire season.
- 5 Click **Start Swiss R1** to generate Round 1 pairings.
- 6 Or go to Admin → Season and click **Start All Swiss** to start all divisions at once.

Post in your Discord server:

Swiss Round 1 is now live! Log in at [your URL] to see your match, lobby name, and password. Report your result when finished!

13. Managing Each Swiss Round

During each round, players handle everything themselves. Your only job is to advance the round when all matches are done.

Who Does What	Action
Players	Find their match in My Portal, get lobby info, play the game, report the result
You (if dispute)	Go to Bracket tab, click Resolve on disputed matches, review recordings, pick winner
You (round advance)	When the Next Round button lights up gold, click it to generate the next round
After Round 7	Click Cut to Top 8 to generate the playoff bracket

Posting round updates to Discord:

After each round, go to the **Discord** tab and copy the division export. Paste it into your bracket channel to keep your community updated.

14. Resolving Disputes

A dispute happens when two players report different results. The header shows a red dispute count.

- 1 Go to the **Bracket** tab — disputed matches are highlighted in red at the top.
- 2 Click **Resolve** next to the match.
- 3 A popup shows what each player reported.
- 4 Ask both players to send you their game recording.
- 5 Review the recording and identify the actual winner.
- 6 Click the correct winner's name in the popup.
- 7 The result is confirmed and the round can continue.

No recording = dispute goes against that player. Make it very clear in your tournament rules that every match must be recorded. This protects everyone.

15. Running the Top 8 Playoff

After 7 Swiss rounds, click **Cut to Top 8** in the Bracket tab. The agent automatically seeds the bracket:

Match	Seeding
Quarterfinal 1	1st seed vs 8th seed
Quarterfinal 2	4th seed vs 5th seed
Quarterfinal 3	2nd seed vs 7th seed
Quarterfinal 4	3rd seed vs 6th seed

Players self-report playoff results the same way as Swiss. Winners advance automatically. When the Grand Final is reported, a champion banner appears.

Post the bracket export to your Discord after each playoff round to keep your community engaged.

16. Exporting to Discord

Go to the **Discord** tab in your tournament for ready-to-paste content.

Export	When to Use
Tournament Announcement	When opening registration
Division bracket exports	After each Swiss round and each playoff round

Click **Copy**, go to your Discord channel, press Ctrl+V to paste, press Enter.

Suggested Discord channel setup:

- 1 **#tournament-info** — pin the announcement here
- 2 **#registration** — post the tournament URL and instructions
- 3 **#bronze-bracket**, **#silver-bracket** etc. — one per division for standings
- 4 **#match-results** — players can screenshot and post their results here as backup

17. Managing Players (Ban, Reports)

Banning a player:

- 1 Go to **Admin** → **Players**.
- 2 Find the player and click **Ban**.
- 3 Confirm in the popup.
- 4 The player is immediately suspended and cannot re-register with the same email.

Reviewing player reports:

- 1 Go to **Admin** → **Reports**.
- 2 Any player misconduct reports appear here with reason and timestamp.
- 3 Review the report and click **Ban Player** if warranted, or **Mark Resolved** if not.

When to ban: Confirmed cheating (modded game files), consistent no-shows with no explanation, harassment of other players. Always warn once for minor issues unless the violation is severe.

18. Your Responsibilities for Prize Distribution

Prize distribution is handled entirely by you as the server host, using the prize fees players paid you directly via PayPal.

Item	Your Responsibility
Receiving prize fees	Players pay your PayPal email directly. You confirm receipt in Admin → Payments.
Prize pool total	Shown live in Admin → Tiers — grows automatically as payments are confirmed Received
Prize split per division	Set once in Admin → Tiers (default 60% / 25% / 15% for 1st/2nd/3rd)
Winner determination	The app crowns a champion for each division — you look up 2nd and 3rd from final standings
Distribution method	Send the prize amounts to winners via PayPal, e-Transfer, or your preferred method
Timeline	Distribute within a reasonable time after the final (within 1 week recommended)

Example: Gold division has 40 confirmed-paid players at \$10 prize fee = \$400 pool. With a 60/25/15 split: 1st place wins \$240, 2nd wins \$100, 3rd wins \$60.

Announce your prize structure publicly before the tournament starts so players know what they are competing for. The live prize pool is visible to everyone on the tournament home page and division cards, which builds trust and excitement as the pool grows.

19. Backup & Data

- 1 Go to **Admin** → **Data**.
- 2 Click **Export Backup** to download a JSON file of all your tournament data.
- 3 Save it to Google Drive or email it to yourself.
- 4 To restore: click **Restore Backup** and select the file.

Back up before and after each weekend of play. This protects against browser storage being cleared accidentally.

20. Quick Reference — Admin Checklist

Before Tournament Starts:

Task	Location	Done?
Change admin password	Admin → Passwords	[]
Set season name and prize fee	Admin → Season	[]
Add your PayPal email	Admin → Season	[]
Configure divisions	Admin → Tiers	[]
Set prize splits per division	Admin → Tiers	[]
Set time windows	Admin → Time Windows	[]
Set placement settings	Admin → Placement	[]
Post Discord announcement	Discord tab → Copy	[]
Open registration	Admin → Season	[]

During Tournament:

Task	Frequency
Confirm payments received (after checking PayPal)	As players submit
Close registration & generate schedule	Once, at registration deadline
Open division brackets	Once, after placements complete
Lock settings	Once, after vote period
Start Swiss rounds	Once, after settings locked
Click Next Round	Once per round (7 times total)
Resolve disputes	As needed

Export to Discord	After each round
Export backup	Before and after each weekend

After Tournament Ends:

Task	Location
Distribute prizes to 1st/2nd/3rd via PayPal	Use final standings + your prize split %
Reset all payments for next season	Admin → Season → Reset All Payments